

BRAND GUIDELINES · FOR CLAUDE CODE

Building the Nua Modular website.

A reference for engineers and AI collaborators implementing nuamodular.ie. Use the tokens, type, and voice rules below as the single source of truth.

V1.0 · MAY 2026
MAINTAINER · NUA MODULAR

01

Brand essence

IN ONE LINE

Modular cabins, made for the Irish outdoors — delivered ready to live in.

PROMISE

Nua Modular delivers factory-built, off-grid-ready living pods on a single flatbed. Move-in happens in hours, not months. The product feels like a quiet, well-made object — not a shipping container, not a tiny-house gimmick.

PILLARS

- **Considered.** Restrained typography, lots of whitespace, no decorative filler.
- **Grounded.** Earthy greens and creams. Imagery rooted in Irish landscapes — coast, garden, mountain, lake.
- **Practical.** Specs and prices are visible, not buried. Trust beats hype.
- **Warm.** Soft golden-hour imagery and serif display type keep the product feeling human, not industrial.

02

Logo

FILES

- `assets/nua-logo-tight.png` — primary lockup (mark + wordmark, 239×241, transparent).
- `assets/nua-logo-mark.png` — mark-only crop (239×178), for tight corners, favicons, social avatars.

Use the lockup whenever there is room for the wordmark. Fall back to the mark only when the lockup would be smaller than ~36 px tall.

TONE VARIANTS

- **Green** — original, on cream / paper / white.
- **White** — apply `filter: brightness(0) invert(1)` on dark backgrounds.
- Never recolor outside the green family. Never add a stroke, glow, or drop shadow.

CLEAR SPACE & SIZE

- Minimum clear space around the logo = height of the "N" glyph in the mark.
- Minimum lockup height on web: `40px` . Mark-only: `24px` .
- Never place over busy parts of an image. Use a 35–55% dark gradient overlay if you must.

Color

PALETTE

Brand Green
#1E5132
PRIMARY

Deep
#143421
HEADERS ·
DARK UI

Mid
#2A6B45
HOVER ·
ACCENTS

Sage
#4A8B5C
TAGS ·
HIGHLIGHTS

Cream
#F5F2EB
SECTION
BG

Paper
#FBFAF6
PAGE BG

Ink
#0E1A12
BODY TEXT

Mute
#7A857E
CAPTIONS ·
META

RULES

- Greens carry meaning (brand, action, accent). Never use greens for danger/error.
- Body text is Ink on Paper or Cream . Never pure black on pure white.
- Reverse: white text on Brand Green or Deep. Maintain WCAG AA (4.5:1) on body copy.
- Never introduce a new hue without approval. No reds, yellows, blues outside the photography.

CSS TOKENS

```
/* Drop into :root, then reference everywhere. */  
--brand: #1E5132;  
--brand-deep: #143421;  
--brand-mid: #2A6B45;  
--brand-sage: #4A8B5C;  
--bg-paper: #FBFAF6;  
--bg-cream: #F5F2EB;  
--text-ink: #0E1A12;  
--text-mute: #7A857E;  
--rule: rgba(30,81,50,0.18);
```

Typography

FAMILIES

Fraunces (Google Fonts) — display, headlines, prices, model names. Weights 300/400/500.

Inter (Google Fonts) — body, UI, labels, captions. Weights 400/500/600/700.

Always load both with `display=swap`. Never substitute system fonts in production.

SPECIMENS

DISPLAY · LETTER-
FRAUNCES SPACING
400 -0.02EM

A
home,
ready
in
hours.

72 / 0.95 Hero
· h1

48 / 1.00 Section
· h2

28 / 1.10 Card · h3

TEXT · INTER LINE-
400/500/600 HEIGHT
1.55

Factory-built, off-
grid-ready and
delivered on a single
flatbed. The S70
sleeps two with a full
kitchen, ensuite and
lounge.

16 / 1.55 Body —
paragraphs
& long
copy

14 / 1.5 UI —
buttons,
nav, links

11 / 1.0 EYEBROW
· CAPTION
· META

RULES

- Headlines use `text-wrap: pretty`, negative letter-spacing, generous max-width.
- Eyebrows and meta use Inter 600, 11px, `letter-spacing: 0.18em-0.28em`, uppercase.
- Never use Fraunces below 18px. Never use Inter italic for display.
- Never use all-caps Fraunces.

Layout & spacing

- GRID
- Max content width `1180px` , centered. Hero sections may go full-bleed.
 - Section vertical rhythm: `96px` desktop, `56px` mobile.
 - 12-column grid, `24px` gutter. Most marketing rows are 2/3 + 1/3 or 1/2 + 1/2.

SPACING SCALE

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
<code>--sp-1</code>	<code>4px</code>	Tight inline gaps
<code>--sp-2</code>	<code>8px</code>	Icon-to-text, chip padding
<code>--sp-3</code>	<code>12px</code>	Form rows
<code>--sp-4</code>	<code>16px</code>	Card padding
<code>--sp-6</code>	<code>24px</code>	Grid gutter
<code>--sp-8</code>	<code>32px</code>	Card-to-card
<code>--sp-12</code>	<code>48px</code>	Block-to-block
<code>--sp-16</code>	<code>64px</code>	Section-to-section (mobile)
<code>--sp-24</code>	<code>96px</code>	Section-to-section (desktop)

RADII & RULES

- Cards / image containers: `4px` . Buttons / pills: `999px` . Inputs: `6px` .
- Hairlines: `1px solid var(--rule)` (a 18%-alpha brand green).
- No drop shadows on cards. Use color + spacing for hierarchy. Hero imagery may have a soft `0 2px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.08)` only when floated over a busy background.

Core components

BUTTONS

- **Primary:** Brand Green bg, white text, pill radius, 13–14px Inter 600 uppercase, letter-spacing 0.06em, padding 14px 28px.
- **Secondary:** transparent bg, Brand Green text, 1.5px Brand Green border, same pill shape.
- **On dark:** invert primary — white bg, Brand Green text.
- **Hover:** shift to --brand-mid. No scale, no shadow.

NAV

- Top-aligned, transparent over hero, opaque Paper elsewhere.
- Items use Inter 400, 14px, uppercase, letter-spacing 0.08em.
- Lockup on left; nav items right; primary CTA pinned right-most.

FORMS

- Single-column. Labels above inputs, Inter 500 13px.
- Inputs: Paper bg, 1px rule border, focus state = --brand border + faint green ring.
- Validation messages: --brand-deep for errors (we keep the palette tight), not red.

Imagery

LIBRARY

Eight approved hero shots live in `assets/photos/`: beach-day, cliff-golden, garden-day, garden-golden, garden-night, garden-office, lake-night, mountain-golden. Use them by mood (see imagery rules below). Do not stretch, crop tightly, or apply heavy filters.

MOOD

- **Hero / homepage:** bright outdoor, sky visible — beach-day or mountain-golden.
- **Storytelling / "about":** golden-hour — cliff-golden, garden-golden.
- **Use cases:** garden-office (workspace), garden-night/lake-night (retreat).
- **Product detail:** garden-day for clean clarity.

RULES



DO

Natural light, environment context, pod composed within the frame, generous sky or landscape.



DON'T

Heavy filters, oversaturation, harsh contrast, "stylized" color grading. Keep tones true to the original capture.

- Treat the image as the hero — let it breathe. Headlines sit at the bottom or to the side, never centered over the pod.
- Use a vertical dark gradient (0 → 70% from bottom) when overlaying text on photography.
- Never use stock images of generic cabins or tiny houses. If a real photo doesn't exist, leave a placeholder.

Voice & copy

tone

Plain-spoken, confident, Irish. Short sentences. Concrete nouns. We sell a building, not a lifestyle — let the imagery do the lifestyle work.

examples

YES

"A home, ready in hours."
"Move-in in a day."
"Delivered on a flatbed. Built to last."

NOT THIS

"Reimagine the way you live."
"Unleash your dream retreat."
"Disruptive modular living solutions."

rules

- Prices and dimensions are public. Show them: `From €58,000 , 9.2 × 3.0 m .`
- Use the en-dash for ranges (`10–4`), the em-dash for emphasis (`– delivered nationwide`).
- Hashtag is `#NuaModular` . URL is `nuamodular.ie` . Never abbreviate to "Nua" in product names.
- Avoid: "innovative", "revolutionary", "luxury", "premium", "elevate", "curate", "bespoke" (unless literally true).

Implementation notes

STACK

- Static-first. Next.js or Astro both fine; prefer SSG with image optimization.
- No CSS framework. Plain CSS with custom properties. The tokens above ARE the design system.
- Icons: line icons only, `1.5px` stroke, current color. No filled icons.

ACCESSIBILITY

- WCAG AA minimum. Body text 4.5:1; large text 3:1.
- Visible focus rings — `2px solid var(--brand-mid)` with `2px` offset.
- All photography needs descriptive `alt`. Decorative imagery uses empty alt + `role="presentation"`.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: no parallax, no auto-scrolling carousels.

PERFORMANCE

- Hero LCP image: WebP/AVIF, <180 KB after compression. Pre-load it.
- Defer Fraunces with `font-display: swap`; Inter is critical, ship in head.
- Target Lighthouse mobile ≥ 90 across the board on launch.

When in doubt, do less.

The product is the point. If a section feels empty, that's a design problem to solve with imagery and whitespace — not by adding filler. Every element earns its place.